Report

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Students and staff receive messages about classes, accounts or payments that may imitate university notices. A suspicious email can request a password or include a link or attachment.

Unsure where to report it, a person may ignore or delete it, delaying the university's response [1]. UniSafe is a proposed web service that gives students and staff a clear way to report suspicious messages and other cyber incidents.

Users choose an incident type, describe what happened, add the date, optionally attach a screenshot, review the details and submit. The service should confirm receipt with a reference number, allow status checks, provide safety advice and show an alternative contact during outages. In the proposed system, a browser sends the report over HTTPS to a university server. The server validates and stores it in a restricted database for authorized IT or security staff. Staff review reports and decide whether follow-up is needed [2]; UniSafe does not automatically classify threats. The interactive prototype uses HTML, CSS and JavaScript to demonstrate report, review, confirmation, error and status screens. It is front-end only: it does not send real reports or upload files. A production version would need server-side validation, protected file storage and access controls [3].

References (not included in word count)

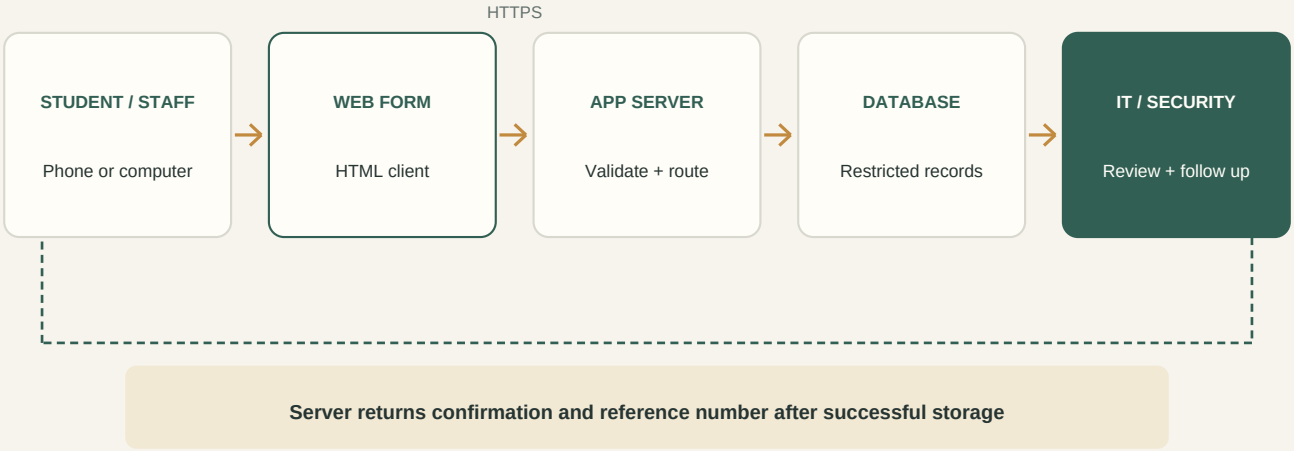
CISA — Recognize and Report Phishing — Open source

NIST — SP 800-61 Rev. 3 (2025) — Open source

OWASP — File Upload Cheat Sheet — Open source

System architecture

Proposed full service — the current prototype has no live backend



IF THE SERVICE CANNOT BE REACHED

Show “report not sent”; provide retry guidance and the official university IT contact.

Data flow

From user input to staff review, with a clear failure branch

Failure branch: if offline or server rejects the request, show “not sent” and the official helpdesk route.

UNIVERSITY ICT PROJECT

UniSafe

Reporting suspicious messages at university

A proposed service that helps students and staff get a concern to the right team.

STUDENT

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GROUP

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REPORT / REVIEW / FOLLOW UP

REPORT RECEIVED

Reference number

When a message looks official, what should you do?

A familiar subject line can still hide a risky link or request.

THE SITUATION

Aliya checks her university email on her phone. One morning, she gets an unexpected message with a link.

She can’t tell if it’s genuine. She doesn’t want to click it, but she also isn’t sure who at the university should hear about it.

WITHOUT A CLEAR REPORTING ROUTE

ignore it

delete it

forward it to the wrong place

WHY IT MATTERS

The same message may have reached other people.

If nobody reports it, the university IT or security team may not know there is a problem until later.

The report should take little effort and tell the user what happens next.

UniSafe gives Aliya one clear next step

A report collects the essentials. A person at the university decides what to do.

1

Choose

Pick the type of incident

2

Describe

Add details and the date

3

Attach

Include a screenshot if useful

4

Review

Check it before sending

5

Keep

Save the reference number

AFTER SUBMISSION

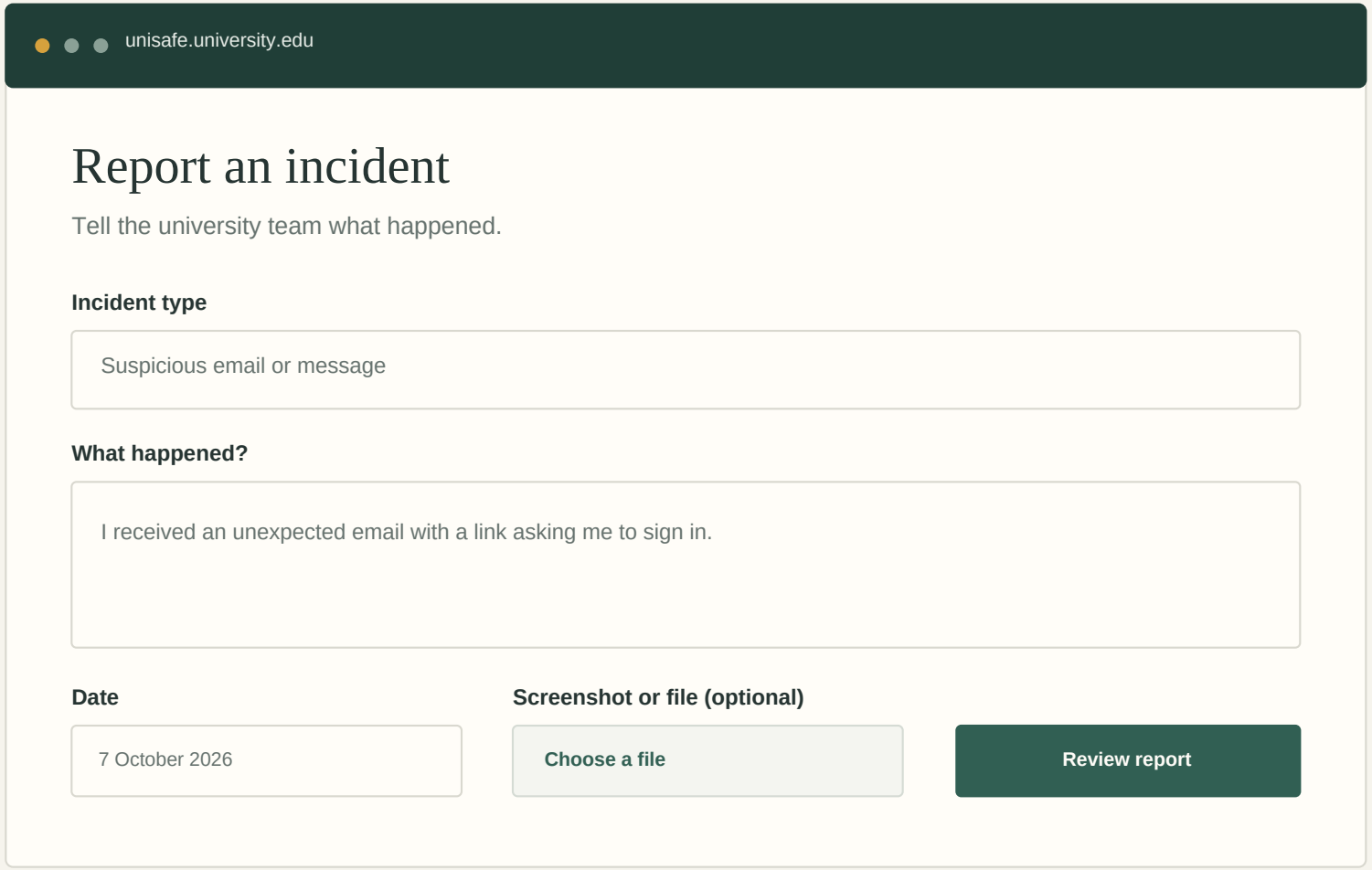
Staff review the report and follow up if needed.

A reference means the report arrived.

Other parts: basic safety advice · status check · alternative instructions if the site is down

The prototype keeps the form straightforward

Users can review the details before UniSafe confirms receipt.



BEFORE SENDING

Check the incident type, date and description.

An attachment is optional.

AFTER SENDING

Report received

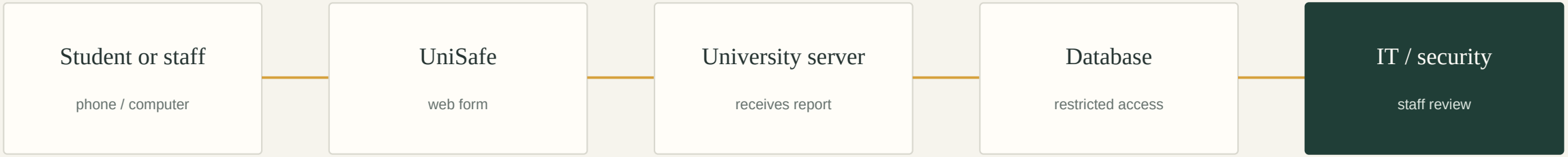
Keep this example reference number:

US-482731

Staff review it; the system does not classify it automatically.

A small web service, with clear limits

The report needs internet to reach the university team.



WHY A WEBSITE

Works on devices people already use; no app install needed.

PROTECTING REPORTS

Only authorized staff should access reports and uploaded files.

IF THE CONNECTION FAILS

Say clearly the report was not sent; show the official helpdesk contact.

This is a concept prototype. Reports are not sent to a real university service.